

Nova Tech Solutions

Employee Handbook 2026

Sample document created for a RAG chatbot practice project. Company and policies are fictional.

1. About the Company

Nova Tech Solutions is a software services company founded in 2015 and headquartered in Hyderabad, India. The company has about 450 employees and additional offices in Bengaluru and Pune. Nova Tech builds web applications, mobile apps and data platforms for clients in banking, healthcare and retail.

Our core values are Integrity, Ownership, Customer Focus and Continuous Learning. Every employee is expected to follow these values in daily work.

This handbook explains the main policies that apply to all full-time employees. For any question not covered here, employees should contact the HR team at hr@novatech-example.com or dial extension 200.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

The standard working week is Monday to Friday. Office hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, which includes a one-hour lunch break. Employees must complete at least 8 working hours per day.

Flexible check-in is allowed between 8:30 AM and 10:30 AM, as long as the daily hours are completed. Employees arriving after 10:30 AM must inform their manager and will be marked as a late arrival.

If an employee records more than 3 late arrivals in a calendar month, half a day of casual leave will be deducted for every additional late arrival.

Attendance is recorded using the biometric system in the office and the NovaHR mobile app for remote days.

3. Leave Policy

Annual leave: Every full-time employee gets 18 paid leave days per year, credited at the start of January. Of these, 12 are casual leave days and 6 are sick leave days.

Sick leave of more than 2 consecutive days requires a medical certificate from a registered doctor. The certificate must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of returning to work.

Earned leave: Employees who complete one full year receive an additional 15 earned leave days each year. Up to 30 earned leave days can be carried forward to the next year. Any balance above 30 days lapses on 31 December.

Maternity leave: Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave.

Paternity leave: Male employees are entitled to 10 working days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth.

Public holidays: The company observes 12 public holidays per year. The holiday list is published every December for the next year.

Leave must be applied for through the NovaHR portal. Leave of more than 3 days must be applied at least 7 days in advance and approved by the reporting manager.

4. Remote and Hybrid Work

Nova Tech follows a hybrid model. Employees are expected to work from the office 3 days a week, usually Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday. Mondays and Fridays are optional remote days.

Employees may work fully remotely for up to 30 days per year with written approval from their manager and the HR team. Requests must be submitted at least 5 working days in advance.

Employees working remotely must be reachable on the company chat tool during office hours and must join all scheduled team meetings with their camera on.

A one-time work-from-home setup allowance of 15,000 INR is given to employees who are approved for the hybrid model, to buy a chair, desk or headset. A monthly internet reimbursement of 1,000 INR is also provided.

5. Expense Reimbursement and Travel

Employees can claim reimbursement for business expenses such as client travel, accommodation, meals during travel and approved training courses. All claims must be submitted through the NovaHR expense module within 30 days of the expense.

Original receipts are required for any single expense above 500 INR. Claims without receipts above this amount will be rejected.

Domestic air travel must be booked in economy class. Hotel stays are limited to 6,000 INR per night in metro cities and 4,000 INR per night in other cities. The daily meal allowance during travel is 800 INR.

Reimbursements are approved by the reporting manager first and then by the Finance team. Approved claims are paid with the next monthly salary, which is credited on the last working day of each month.

6. IT and Information Security

All company laptops are encrypted. Employees must not install unapproved software. Software requests can be raised on the IT helpdesk at it-help@novatech-example.com.

Passwords must be at least 12 characters long and changed every 90 days. Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, the VPN and the code repository.

Client data must never be copied to personal devices, personal email or public cloud storage. Violating this rule is treated as a serious misconduct case.

Any lost laptop, phone or suspected security incident must be reported to the IT security team within 2 hours of discovery by calling the 24x7 security hotline on extension 911.

USB storage devices are blocked by default. Exceptions need written approval from the IT Security Head.

7. Code of Conduct

Nova Tech has zero tolerance for harassment, discrimination or bullying of any kind. Complaints can be raised with HR or the Internal Complaints Committee (ICC). All complaints are handled confidentially, and retaliation against a person who complains is strictly prohibited.

Employees must declare any conflict of interest to HR. Accepting gifts worth more than 2,000 INR from clients or vendors is not allowed without written approval from the department head.

Working for another company or taking freelance work while employed at Nova Tech (moonlighting) is not permitted.

Social media: Employees must not share confidential company or client information online and should make clear that personal opinions are their own.

8. Performance Reviews and Promotions

Performance is reviewed twice a year, in June (mid-year review) and December (annual review). Each review includes a self-assessment, a manager assessment and a short feedback discussion.

Ratings use a 5-point scale: 1 (Needs Improvement), 2 (Partially Meets), 3 (Meets Expectations), 4 (Exceeds Expectations) and 5 (Outstanding).

Employees with a rating of 4 or above in the annual review are eligible for promotion consideration. Salary increments are decided after the annual review and are effective from 1 April.

Employees rated 1 or 2 are placed on a 90-day Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) with clear goals and fortnightly check-ins with their manager.

9. Benefits

Health insurance: Nova Tech provides group health insurance with a cover of 5 lakh INR for the employee, spouse and up to 2 children. Parents can be added by paying an additional premium.

Learning budget: Each employee gets 25,000 INR per year for approved courses, certifications and conferences. Employees who receive reimbursement for a certification must stay with the company for at least 12 months after completion, or repay the amount.

Provident Fund: The company contributes 12 percent of basic salary to the employee's Provident Fund, matching the employee's own 12 percent contribution.

Referral bonus: Employees receive 30,000 INR for referring a candidate who is hired and completes 6 months with the company.

Free lunch is provided on all office days at the cafeteria in the Hyderabad and Bengaluru offices.

10. Joining, Notice Period and Exit

New employees have a probation period of 6 months. During probation, the notice period is 30 days. After confirmation, the notice period is 60 days for all employees up to Senior Engineer level and 90 days for Lead and above.

On the last working day, employees must return the laptop, ID card and any other company assets. The full and final settlement is paid within 45 days of the last working day.

Employees can request an experience letter and relieving letter from HR after completing the exit formalities.